

Atrix 2 to have 8 MP cam

The successor to the Atrix to come with a 8 megapixel camera
<http://bit.ly/pIgvuk>



The Tempest

NZXT is launching its Tempest 210 chassis. Check out the details here...
<http://bit.ly/o6DqBL>

Motorola Xoom MZ601

Betrayed by its apps ecosystem



Specifications

Platform: Android 3.1;
Processor: ARM Cortex A9 dual core 1GHz, Tegra 2 chipset, 1GB RAM; **Display:** 10.1-inch, 1280x800 pixel, TFT type; **Storage:** 32GB built-in, microSD slot; **Camera:** 5MP with 720p HD video; **Connectivity:** 3G, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth

Contact

Motorola Mobility India
Phone: 1800-30004343
Email: info.in@motorola.com
Web site: <http://www.motorola.com/Consumers/IN-EN/Home>
Price: ₹39,990

7.0
10

Features8.0
 Performance.....7.0
 Build Quality7.5
 Value for Money6.5

Motorola's Xoom Android tablet finally arrived on hither shores some time ago. Will this eagerly-awaited tablet successfully rise to the challenge of the Apple iPad (2)? Or will it become a high-profile footnote in a long list of Android tablets that tried staging a long seige on Apple's crown jewel? We take a closer look at how the Motorola Xoom performs in a tablet war that is defining the post-PC world.

Looks are really a case of two extremes here. The Motorola Xoom sports a solid and classy build as well as a comparatively different look (compared to the iPad) combined with a bulky form factor. At 13mm, the Motorola Xoom is no doubt thicker than the iPad 2 which measures at 8.8mm. Also, the Motorola Xoom tips the scales at 730 grams while the iPad 2 weighs just a bit more than 600 grams. No doubt, at all over which of the two tablets feel thinner and lighter in your hands.

Layout

The Motorola Xoom Android tablet's power key is placed on the rear panel, the logic being that it's easier to reach the key with the finger while holding the tablet in its normal usage position — makes sense.

Android 3.1 has come up with a completely redesigned UI for the Motorola Xoom. For instance, the tablet's battery level, wireless connectivity and cellular network info now show up on the bottom-right edge of the display — otherwise traditional Android tablets and smartphones display this information on the top status bar. The Motorola Xoom instead displays an app list in the top-right corner. The bottom-left corner has the return, home and task options.

Usability

We slotted a Vodafone SIM card in the Motorola Xoom to check out the experience. Any messages that were received on that number showed up as a pop-up on the tablet's home screen. These SMSes weren't stored anywhere, but the pop-ups didn't disappear unless you clicked on "OK". This is pretty neat, because the device doesn't allow voice calls.

Performance

In terms of the power game, the Xoom does pack a significant punch. In simple terms, apps ran much more smoothly than we expected. Games loaded the quickest among all Android tablets so far. Multitasking didn't really slow down the tablet at all, and the new task manager introduced with Android

3.1 does make for a visually appealing package.

Weirdly though, if you're transferring anything to the Xoom via the data cable, the OS completely freezes and refuses to respond till the file transfer is complete.

New browser

What makes our eyes tear with happiness is the new web browser! The Chrome browser-like UI allows you to stack multiple tabs. However, the biggest problem with the Xoom's 10-inch display is that the white colours aren't really white. The shade is pale, and that won't look good on most web pages. Video viewing was pretty impressive on the 10-inch display, but there was a distinct lack of sharpness, even with HD content. Battery life, however, is a bit of a disappointment. The battery ran out completely in about three hours of continuous use as a web browsing device and a hotspot.

Conclusion

There's a lot to like about the Motorola Xoom, especially after tweaks and updates collectively make it a much better device. The biggest problem isn't the Xoom, but the dearth of tablet-friendly apps — it seems only iOS is hot when it comes to this class of device form factor.

The Motorola Xoom is a good tablet, but really, tablets are little more than the sum of apps that run on them, and at the moment, the iPad is a much better ecosystem.

Visbal Mathur